CONFIDENTIAL — DRAFT — FOR DISCUSSION · AMOUNT AND TERMS NOT SET

The round the bridge is built to reach. Capital follows evidence.

Objective #3 of the capital-readiness bridge is “define measurable go / no-go criteria and prepare the next round.” This page is the structure of that round as the program documents already describe it. The amount, the pre-money and the instrument are the founder’s decisions with counsel and are not stated here.

WHAT THE SEED FUNDS

Period	Work	Decision at the end
Tranche A released at close	Gate 1 — Characterize. Commission the artifact-exclusion bench and publish its error budget (thread C); run the pre-registered replication of the strongest published claim (thread B); characterize the founder’s solid-state module under exactly the same protocol (thread A). Hire the principal investigator — a condition of Tranche A, not an aspiration.	Gate-1 report, advisory-board certification, publication → Tranche B, or wind-down with unspent escrow returned.
Tranche B escrowed	Gate 2 — Conservation test. Closed-system calorimetry; mechanism discrimination against known-source models; independent replication at a second laboratory contracted before Gate 2 begins.	Gate-2 report → Tranche C, or the effect is retired publicly.
Tranche C escrowed	Gate 3 — Extract or retire. Engineering characterization, lifetime and stability, third-party validation; the anti-tamper paperweight test.	First public performance disclosure, or the program ends having answered the question.

> Tranches B and C sit in escrow from the close and are released only on a written gate report, advisory-board certification and publication of the gate results. Investors receive the same report the public does. This converts “too early for us” — the objection the company has already heard from one fund — into a staged option: an investor underwrites Tranche A and a decision, not a three-year belief.

WHAT THE RAISE MODEL SAYS — AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

Figure	Value	Origin
36-month plan, Base scenario (model v1, Sept 2026)	$17.07M plan spend · $20.49M raise incl. 20% reserve	**Model output on placeholder inputs** — not a raise figure. Lean $14.44M / $17.33M; Full $20.92M / $25.11M.
Model v2 (Sept 11, 2026)	$19.68M base · $23.40M with the full engineering band	Model output on placeholder inputs; the v2 workbook is referenced by the September manifest and **not located** in the inventory.
Gate months (model)	Gate 1 month 9 · Gate 2 month 21 · Gate 3 month 36	Placeholder inputs (Assumptions!B11–B13).
Largest single open input	Two theoretical-physicist consulting agreements modelled at $500k/yr *each*	Founder’s wording was “a consultant agreement of half a million a year”; if that is $500k total, every headline number falls.

Tranche sizes	—	Not stated. The model computes cumulative need at each gate month; the figures are not reproduced here because the workbook's cached values are not in the package and every input is unvalidated.

OPEN BEFORE THIS ROUND CAN BE DEFINED

- Amount, pre-money and instrument — founder with counsel. OPEN
- Every placeholder in the raise model validated by finance: founder salary, engineer bases, rent, build-out, instrumentation package, precision additive-manufacturing system, insurance, recruiting; the $500k-each question. OPEN
- Escrow: agreement, agent and bank confirmed directly, release conditions, no fee to release. OPEN
- General solicitation (506(b) vs 506(c)) answered before any deck reaches an investor who has not heard from the company. OPEN
- Entity formed; IP assigned in; advisor consents on file; PI identified. OPEN

ANCESTRY

The September 2026 Investor Overview (20 slides, DataRoom v1 DRAFT, SHA-256 ad53f314…2a31a) carried this gate-tranched structure with bracketed placeholders and is retained in this folder unedited as a historical draft; it is not for circulation. A 13-slide "Series A" deck of 11 Sept 2026 is referenced by the September manifest and not located.

Sources: Investor Overview slides 11–13, 17–19 (M-04); Financial_Status_2026-09-18 and Raise Model v1 README / Assumptions / UseOfFunds (M-02, M-03b); Program_Summary_and_Gates (M-03b); DECISIONS.md D1 (resolved — separate Seed folder; Capital Readiness originals preserved).